

Modifiers & Sentence Logic

Workbook 1 - Learn - Focused practice

Directions

Focus on the rule and explain why the other choices fail.

Exercise 1

After reading the instructions, the machine was started by Elena.

Task: Choose the clearest revision.

- A. After reading the instructions, Elena started the machine.
- B. After reading the instructions, the machine was started by Elena.
- C. Reading the instructions, the machine started Elena.
- D. After the instructions, Elena was machine starting.

Exercise 2

Riders should only call after they receive a match notice.

Task: Move only to show that the timing, not the action, is limited.

- A. Only riders should call after they receive a match notice.
- B. Riders should call only after they receive a match notice.
- C. Riders only should call after they receive a match notice.
- D. Riders should call after only they receive a match notice.

Exercise 3

The coordinator almost reviewed fifty forms.

Task: Choose the revision meaning that about fifty forms were reviewed.

- A. The coordinator reviewed almost fifty forms.
- B. The coordinator almost reviewed fifty forms.
- C. Almost the coordinator reviewed fifty forms.
- D. The coordinator reviewed fifty almost forms.

Exercise 4

Walking through the lobby, the new signs were easy to see.

Task: Choose the logical revision.

- A. Walking through the lobby, visitors could easily see the new signs.
- B. Walking through the lobby, the new signs were easy to see.
- C. The signs, walking through the lobby, were easy to see.
- D. Walking, the lobby showed signs.

Answer reasoning

Check the rule and the meaning, not only the letter.

For every miss, identify whether the problem was grammar, punctuation, word meaning, sentence logic, or a rushed reading of the context.

Exercise 1

Best answer: A. After reading the instructions, Elena started the machine.

Why: Elena is the person who read the instructions, so her name follows the opening phrase.

Exercise 2

Best answer: B. Riders should call only after they receive a match notice.

Why: Only directly limits the after-clause.

Exercise 3

Best answer: A. The coordinator reviewed almost fifty forms.

Why: Almost directly modifies fifty.

Exercise 4

Best answer: A. Walking through the lobby, visitors could easily see the new signs.

Why: Visitors, not signs, can walk through the lobby.

Mistake check

Rewrite one missed sentence correctly. Then state the rule in one short sentence you could use on a new example.